ABINGDON. Two dirty day-rooms; and three offensive night-rooms: that for men eight feet square: one of the women's, nine by eight; the other four and a half feet square: the straw, worn to dust, swarmed with vermin: no court: no water accessible to prisoners. The petty offenders were in irons: at my last visit, eight were women. Allowance, if felons, threepence a day. Keeper's salary, £18: fees, 4s. 4d., no table. At all my visits the prisoners had no employment.

1776, 2 Jan. prisoners 3. 1782, 25 Dec. prisoners 13, drs. 1.
1779, 22 Apr. „ 3.

WINDSOR CASTLE PRISON, for debtors. I need not observe that his Majesty is proprietor. The Duke of Montague is constable: he appoints a janitor with a salary: the janitor appoints a deputy, who for a house rent-free, and certain perquisites, does the duty. The prison out of repair. It consists of three rooms on the first floor and three rooms over them.

At my last visit I found that the old keeper had been murdered in the tap-room by a soldier, who also killed another, and was then shot himself. This is not the first instance I have known of persons being murdered in the tap-room of gaols. Such are the bad effects of selling liquors in prisons.

habit of idleness or inability to labour in future, is in danger of being acquired. The beneficial effects on the mind, of such a punishment, are speedy, proceeding from the horror of a vicious person left entirely to his own reflections. This may wear off by long continuance, and a sullen insensibility may succeed.

"In all manufacturing towns it would be proper to have solitary cells for the confinement of faulty apprentices and servants for a few days, where they should be constrained to work, and have no visitors unless clergymen: for a short term would probably do more to effect a reformation, than three or four months' confinement; as it is generally found that in the first two or three days prisoners seem to have their minds most affected and penitent.

"A county magistrate said: 'We have thought it necessary to refrain from commitment in many cases where that mode of proceeding would otherwise have been salutary, from a full persuasion of the total unfitness of the places of confinement or of correction, to answer those reformatory purposes for which a well-regulated restraint is peculiarly calculated.'"

OXFORDSHIRE

COUNTY GAOL, OXFORD CASTLE

Gaoler. Solomon Wisdom.
Salary: £20.
Fees: Debtors, £0 9s. 2d.
Felons, £0 15s. 10d.
Transports: He made a bill of the expense.
Licence: Beer and wine.

Prisoners.
Allowance: Debtors, none. (*See* remarks.)
Felons, County, 16d. each per week in bread; City, 1s. (*See* remarks.)
Garnish: Cancelled.
Number:

	Debtors	Felons, etc.		Debtors	Felons, etc.
1773. 26 Nov.	14	13	1779. 25 Feb.	12	15
1774. 4 July	11	17	1779. 29 July	13	4
1776. 2 Jan.	13	10	1782. 28 April	16	10
1776. 31 Oct.	7	14	1782. 25 Dec.	25	31

Chaplain. Rev. Mr. Swinton, now Rev. Mr. Cotton.
Duty: Sunday, Wednesday, Friday; the sacrament four times a year.
Salary: £50, now £40.

Surgeon. Mr. Rawlins.
Salary: £25 for felons.

For the castle gaol the county pays £40 a year to Mr. Etty, who holds it of Christchurch College on lease. Debtors' apartments small; and not enough of them for the general number of prisoners. No free ward: for lodging even in the tower on their own beds they must pay 1s. 6d. a week: see the table. Their court is too small. Felons' day-room or hall for men and women down five steps, twenty-three feet by eleven, the men's dungeon (eighteen and a half feet by sixteen and a half), down five more; only small apertures: the women's night-room six and a half feet by four feet two inches. The court common to both, twenty-nine feet by twenty-three. The gaoler has a spacious garden.

Since the north gate was taken down, this prison has been also the city gaol: for which Mr. Wisdom has £5 a year. In 1773, eleven died of the smallpox. In 1774, that distemper